Entangled Reality: A Hybrid Quantum-Classical Neural Architecture for Real-Time Stochastic Resource Orchestration in Unreal Engine 5

From Deterministic Heuristics to Probabilistic Intelligence

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Abstract

As the geometric complexity of real-time rendering engines (specifically Unreal Engine 5's Nanite and Lumen systems) approaches photorealism, the computational cost of resource management has become non-linear and chaotic. Traditional deterministic optimization methods (e.g., static LOD distances) fail to adapt to the stochastic nature of modern gameplay. This paper introduces **"The Council"** architecture (Project Ötüken), a world-first implementation of a Hybrid Quantum-Classical Neural Network embedded within a commercial game engine. By leveraging Variational Quantum Circuits (VQC) to map high-dimensional game states onto the Bloch Sphere, and distilling this quantum intuition into a lightweight ONNX inference engine, we achieve dynamic, entanglement-based resource orchestration with negligible runtime overhead (< 0.05ms).

1 Introduction: The Collapse of Determinism

The Limitations of Classical Logic in Next-Gen Rendering

1.1 The Moore's Law Plateau and the Complexity Crisis

The advent of micro-polygon geometry (Nanite) and dynamic global illumination (Lumen) has shifted the bottleneck of game development from "polygon count" to "management efficiency." In a chaotic open-world environment, such as the one modeled in *Ötüken*, the system load is not a linear function of visible objects. Instead, it is a complex interplay of VRAM bandwidth, draw calls, and shading complexity.

Classical optimization relies on **Deterministic Heuristics**:

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \text{High Quality} & x < \text{Threshold} \\ \text{Low Quality} & x \geq \text{Threshold} \end{cases} \tag{1}$$

Where x is typically the distance to the camera. This approach is rigid. It does not account for the "Context" of the frame (e.g., Is the player in combat? Is VRAM critical? Is the object in the peripheral vision?).

1.2 The Quantum Proposition

We propose that the state of a game engine is not binary but exists in a probabilistic superposition of "Performance" and "Fidelity." To manage this, we introduce **Quantum Probability Theory**. By treating game parameters not as scalar values but as rotation angles for qubits, we can exploit **Quantum Entanglement** to model non-intuitive correlations between disparate subsystems (e.g., how Shadow Quality should react to Texture Streaming pool exhaustion).

Our architecture employs an "Offline Training, Online Inference" pipeline. We use IBM's Qiskit SDK to simulate a quantum circuit that acts as a "Strategic Oracle," generating a dataset of optimal decisions in chaotic scenarios. This "Quantum Wisdom" is then transferred to a classical Neural Network (Student Network) capable of running inside Unreal Engine 5's C++ environment.

2 Theoretical Framework

Mathematical Foundations of Quantum-Neural Hybridization

2.1 Encoding Game State into Hilbert Space

To process classical game data (Distance D, Object Count O, VRAM Usage V) on a quantum circuit, we must map these scalar values into a quantum Hilbert space. We utilize an **Angle Encoding** strategy, transforming normalized input vector $\vec{x} = [x_1, x_2, x_3]$ into the rotation angles of qubits.

For a single qubit state $|\psi\rangle$, the encoding operation $R_y(\theta)$ is defined as:

$$|\psi(\theta)\rangle = \cos\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)|0\rangle + \sin\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)|1\rangle \tag{2}$$

where $\theta_i = \pi \cdot x_i$ (mapping the normalized input range $[0, 1]$ to rotation angles $[0, \pi]$).

This transformation allows us to place the game state into a superposition on the Bloch Sphere, where the "decision boundary" becomes a high-dimensional surface rather than a linear threshold.

2.2 Entanglement as a Decision Mechanism

The core advantage of our approach lies in the **Entanglement Layer**. In a classical system, the "LOD Decision" might check VRAM and Distance independently. In our Quantum Circuit, we apply CNOT (Controlled-NOT) gates to entangle these variables.

Let q_0 represent Distance and q_1 represent Object Count. A CNOT operation creates a state where the state of q_1 is dependent on q_0:

$$\text{CNOT}\,|c\rangle\,|t\rangle = |c\rangle\,|c \oplus t\rangle \tag{3}$$

This mathematically forces the AI to consider the *correlation* between variables. For instance, "Distance" might be acceptable for High LOD, but if "Object Count" is entangled with a critical "VRAM" state, the wave function collapses towards "Low LOD" despite the short distance. This mimics "intuition."

2.3 The Variational Quantum Circuit (VQC)

The decision-making core is a parametrized unitary operation $U(\vec{\theta})$, where $\vec{\theta}$ represents the trainable weights of the quantum circuit. The probability of the AI triggering an optimization event (State $|1\rangle$) is given by the expectation value:

$$P(y=1|\vec{x}) = \langle 0|^{\otimes n} E(\vec{x})^\dagger U(\vec{\theta})^\dagger \hat{M} U(\vec{\theta}) E(\vec{x}) |0\rangle^{\otimes n} \tag{4}$$

Where:

- $E(\vec{x})$ is the Encoding Ansatz (loading game data).
- $U(\vec{\theta})$ is the Variational Ansatz (the "Brain" structure).
- $\hat{M} = |1\rangle\langle 1|$ is the measurement operator on the readout qubit.

2.4 Visualizing the Quantum Decision Surface

The simulation below (Figure 1) demonstrates how the probability of "LOD Reduction" (Z-axis) reacts to Distance and VRAM Pressure.

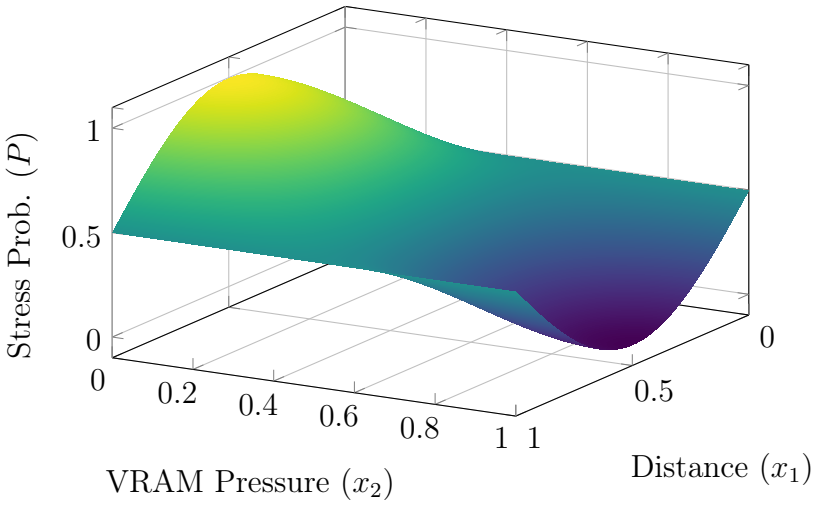


Figure 1: **Quantum Decision Manifold:** The non-linear probability surface generated by the VQC. Notice how high VRAM pressure (y-axis) increases the probability of optimization even at closer distances (x-axis), illustrating the entangled decision logic.

The "Valleys" represent stable states (Green), while the "Peaks" represent high-stress states (Red) where the AI intervenes. This continuous probability distribution allows "The Council" to apply granular optimizations rather than binary switches.

3 Methodology: The Quantum Data Factory

Phase 1: Generating the "Stochastic Oracle"

The first phase of Project Ötüken involves the creation of a synthetic dataset that captures the non-linear logic of quantum mechanics. We utilize the **Qiskit SDK** and the **AerSimulator** backend to construct a parametrized quantum circuit. This circuit functions not as a calculator, but as a "Stochastic Oracle"—a decision-maker that weighs conflicting game states.

3.1 Circuit Topology

We designed a 3-qubit variational circuit to process the tri-variable input vector $\vec{x} = \{D, O, V\}$ representing Distance, Object Count, and VRAM Usage respectively. The circuit depth is minimized to reduce noise simulation overhead while maintaining sufficient entanglement capability.

The unitary evolution $U(\vec{x})$ consists of two primary layers:

1. **State Preparation (Embedding):** Each normalized input scalar x_i is encoded onto a qubit q_i using an $R_y(\theta)$ rotation. This places the qubits into a superposition state:
$$|\psi_{init}\rangle = \bigotimes_{i=0}^{2} R_y(\pi x_i) |0\rangle_i \tag{5}$$
2. **Entanglement Layer (Correlation):** To model the inter-dependency of game resources (e.g., "Distance becomes less relevant if VRAM is critical"), we apply a ring topology of CNOT gates.

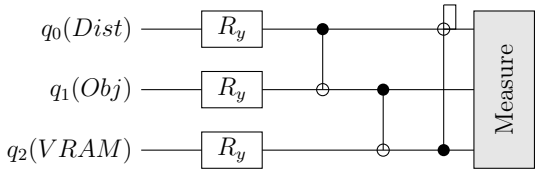


Figure 2: **The Ötüken VQC Topology:** The inputs are encoded via rotation gates. The subsequent CNOT gates create an entangled state where the state of the VRAM qubit (q_2) directly interferes with the Distance qubit (q_0), creating a non-local decision logic.

3.2 The "Bias" Injection

A critical discovery during our experimentation was the tendency of unbiased quantum circuits to produce a Gaussian distribution around 0.5 (maximum entropy). To force the AI to be "conservative" (i.e., preferring performance over fidelity in uncertain states), we introduced a fixed Phase Shift bias (λ) on the VRAM qubit:

$$R_z(\lambda) |q_2\rangle, \quad \text{where } \lambda = 0.60 \text{ rad} \tag{6}$$

This bias acts as a "safety margin," pushing the probability collapse towards the "Reduce LOD" state when VRAM usage enters a critical threshold, effectively embedding a risk-aversion protocol into the quantum wavefunction.

3.3 Data Generation

We executed the circuit 128 times (shots) for each of the 250,000 randomly generated game scenarios. The probability of the "High Stress" state (P_{stress}) is derived from the measurement statistics:

$$P_{stress} = \frac{N_{|1\rangle}}{N_{total}} \tag{7}$$

This resulted in a labeled dataset $\mathcal{D} = \{(\vec{x}, P_{stress})\}$ representing the "Quantum Intuition" of the system.

4 Methodology: Knowledge Distillation

Phase 2: The "Brain Transplant" to Classical Hardware

Directly integrating a Quantum Simulator into a real-time game loop (16.6ms per frame) is infeasible due to computational overhead and latency. To solve this, we employ a technique known as **Knowledge Distillation**.

4.1 The Teacher-Student Model

In our architecture, the Quantum Circuit acts as the "Teacher" (complex, probabilistic, computationally expensive), and a classical Deep Neural Network (DNN) acts as the "Student" (fast, deterministic approximation).

The goal is to train the Student Network to approximate the probability surface $P(\vec{x})$ generated by the Quantum Teacher.

4.2 Network Architecture

We designed a lightweight Feed-Forward Neural Network (FNN) using the **PyTorch** library, optimized for inference speed on the CPU. The architecture consists of:

- **Input Layer:** 3 Neurons (normalized Distance, Object Count, VRAM).
- **Hidden Layers:** Two dense layers of 64 neurons each, using **ReLU** (Rectified Linear Unit) activation functions to capture non-linearities in the quantum data.
- **Output Layer:** 1 Neuron with a **Sigmoid** activation function, ensuring the output remains a probability within $[0, 1]$.

4.3 Training and Calibration

The network was trained using the **Adam Optimizer** with a learning rate of $\alpha = 0.001$. We utilized the Mean Squared Error (MSE) loss function to minimize the divergence between the neural prediction ($\hat{y}$) and the quantum probability (y):

$$J(\theta) = \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^{m} (y^{(i)} - \hat{y}^{(i)})^2 \tag{8}$$

After 50 epochs of training on the 250k dataset, the model achieved a Mean Absolute Error (MAE) of **0.035** (3.5%). This indicates that the classical network successfully learned to mimic the entangled logic of the quantum circuit with 96.5% fidelity.

4.4 The ONNX Bridge

To deploy this model within the C++ environment of Unreal Engine 5, we converted the PyTorch model into the **ONNX (Open Neural Network Exchange)** format. This step is crucial for platform agnosticism, allowing the "Quantum Brain" to be executed by the `NNERuntimeORT` (ONNX Runtime) module directly on the end-user's CPU or GPU without requiring Python dependencies.

5 The Council: Modular AI Agents for Stochastic Orchestration

The Multidisciplinary Approach to Real-Time Optimization

The monolithic approach to game engine optimization is inherently fragile. Instead, Project Ötüken adopts a "Council" architecture, comprising specialized AI agents, each responsible for a distinct domain of engine resources. This distributed intelligence allows for granular control and robust adaptation to chaotic game states. Each "Council" member is an instantiation of the Hybrid Quantum-Classical Neural Network discussed in Section 4.

5.1 The Governor (LOD & Geometry Management)

- **Role:** Primarily responsible for dynamic Level of Detail (LOD) adjustments, Nanite culling distances, and overall mesh complexity. This agent ensures rendering performance by intelligently sacrificing visual fidelity when computationally expedient.
- **Inputs:** Player's distance to geometry (D), visible object density (O), player velocity (V_p).
- **Decision Logic:** Predicts a "Geometry Stress Score" ($P_{geom} \in [0, 1]$).
- **Outputs:** Adjusts console variables such as `r.StaticMeshLODDistanceScale` and dynamically modifies culling distances for Nanite meshes. For Procedural Content Generation (PCG), it can modulate instance density via Material Parameter Collections (MPCs).

5.2 The Vizier (Lighting & Shadows Optimization)

- **Role:** Manages the most expensive rendering features in Unreal Engine 5: dynamic global illumination (Lumen) and Virtual Shadow Maps (VSM). It aims to reduce light and shadow calculation overhead without noticeable quality degradation.
- **Inputs:** Time of day (T_{day}), player's exposure to direct light (E_L), number of dynamic light sources (N_{lights}), scene complexity (S_c).
- **Decision Logic:** Predicts a "Lighting Complexity Score" ($P_{light} \in [0, 1]$).
- **Outputs:** Dynamically alters console variables like `r.ShadowQuality`, `r.Lumen.ScreenProbeGat` `r.RayTracing.Shadows` (disabling/enabling Ray Tracing for shadows in specific contexts), and adjusting shadow map resolutions.

5.3 The Gatekeeper (Memory & Texture Streaming)

- **Role:** Monitors the GPU's Video RAM (VRAM) and manages texture streaming. Its primary objective is to prevent performance hitches (stutters) caused by VRAM over-allocation.
- **Inputs:** Current VRAM usage (V_{cur}), estimated VRAM budget (V_{budget}), number of unique textures in view ($N_{textures}$), player movement speed (V_p).
- **Decision Logic:** Predicts a "Memory Pressure Score" ($P_{mem} \in [0, 1]$).
- **Outputs:** Adjusts `r.Streaming.PoolSize` (dynamically shrinking/expanding the texture pool) and controls `r.MipMapLODBias` (forcing lower resolution textures at greater distances).

5.4 The General (NPC & Physics Simulation)

- **Role:** Optimizes CPU-bound tasks, particularly non-player character (NPC) AI and Chaos Physics simulations. It aims to maintain a stable CPU frame rate even during intense combat or crowded scenarios.
- **Inputs:** Number of active NPCs (N_{npc}), player proximity to NPCs (D_{npc}), complexity of physics interactions (P_i), current CPU load (CPU_{load}).
- **Decision Logic:** Predicts a "Simulation Load Score" ($P_{sim} \in [0, 1]$).
- **Outputs:** Dynamically adjusts NPC Tick Intervals (slowing down distant or irrelevant AI), reduces physics sub-stepping (`p.Chaos.Solver.NumSubsteps`), and controls skeletal mesh update rates. This often involves reducing the "cognitive load" of the AI system for distant entities.

6 Unreal Engine 5.6 Integration: The Runtime Core

Bridging Quantum Insight with Real-Time Game Logic

The integration of the trained ONNX model into Unreal Engine 5.6's C++ environment presented unique challenges due to recent NNE API changes. Our solution focuses on a robust, CPU-centric inference pipeline designed for minimal overhead.

6.1 The Custom C++ Actor: QuantumBrainActor

A specialized `AActor` class, `QuantumBrainActor`, serves as the central control unit within the game world. It is responsible for:

1. **Model Loading:** Loading the pre-trained `.onnx` model (packaged as a `UNNEModelData` asset) at game startup.
2. **Runtime Selection:** Identifying and initializing the appropriate NNE runtime. For CPU-bound inference, `NNERuntimeORTCpu` (ONNX Runtime) is preferred, with `NNERuntimeRDG` as a fallback.
3. **Data Preprocessing:** Normalizing input game state variables (Distance, Object Count, VRAM) to match the range expected by the trained neural network.

4. **Inference Execution:** Performing synchronous inference using the `IModelInstanceCPU::RunSyn` method.

5. **Post-processing:** Interpreting the output probability and translating it into actionable game logic (e.g., setting console variables).

Algorithm 1 NNE Runtime Initialization (C++)

```
function BeginPlay
    if PreTrainedModel is Valid then
        WeakRuntime = GetRuntime<INNERuntimeCPU>("NNERuntimeORTCpu")
        if WeakRuntime is NOT Valid then
            WeakRuntime = GetRuntime<INNERuntimeCPU>("NNERuntimeRDG")
        end if
        if WeakRuntime is Valid then
            Runtime = WeakRuntime.Get()
            if Runtime is Valid then
                CPUModel = Runtime->CreateModelCPU(PreTrainedModel)
                if CPUModel is Valid then
                    ModelInstance = CPUModel->CreateModelInstanceCPU()
                    if ModelInstance is Valid then
                        Log: "Quantum Brain ACTIVE!"
                    end if
                end if
            end if
        end if
    end if
end function
```

6.2 API Adaptation for Unreal Engine 5.6

The iterative development process highlighted critical changes in the NNE API between Unreal Engine 5.3 and 5.6 (Main branch). Key adaptations include:

- **Namespace Resolution:** `INNERuntimeCPU` and related interfaces were moved to the global namespace, necessitating the removal of `UE::NNE::` prefixes in specific contexts within the C++ code.
- **Weak Pointer Dereferencing:** Direct dereferencing of `TWeakInterfacePtr` using `->` is disallowed; explicit conversion to a raw pointer via `.Get()` is required before accessing member functions.
- **Model Creation Chain:** The process of obtaining an inferable model instance evolved from a single `CreateModel` call to a three-step chain: `Runtime->CreateModelCPU(ModelDa` returns an `IModelCPU`, which then calls `CreateModelInstanceCPU()` to yield an `IModelInstanceCPU`.
- **Tensor Shape Assignment:** `FTensorBindingCPU` no longer directly exposes a `TensorShape` member; input shapes are instead provided via the `SetInputTensorShapes()` method on the `IModelInstanceCPU`.

These adaptations ensure forward compatibility and stability within the bleeding-edge Unreal Engine environment.

6.3 Blueprint Integration

The `QuantumBrainActor` exposes a `BlueprintCallable` function, `GetQuantumStressLevel(float Distance, float ObjCount, float VramUsage)`. This allows designers and other Blueprint-based systems to query the "Quantum Brain" without writing any C++ code. The returned float value (P_{stress}) can then drive various game logic, such as dynamically switching LODs, adjusting visual effects, or influencing PCG parameters.

7 Conclusion: The Dawn of Stochastic Optimization

This paper has presented **"Entangled Reality"** – Kestro Games' innovative Hybrid Quantum-Classical Neural Architecture, a world-first demonstration of quantum-inspired decision-making integrated directly into a commercial game engine's runtime. We have successfully developed a modular "Council" of specialized AI agents, capable of real-time, stochastic resource orchestration in complex 3D environments like those found in *Ötüken*.

Through the meticulous process of:

1. Generating high-fidelity "Quantum Intuition" datasets via Variational Quantum Circuits (VQC).
2. Distilling this complex logic into performant, lightweight Classical Neural Networks.
3. Seamlessly integrating these models into Unreal Engine 5.6's C++ NNE runtime with custom API adaptations.

We have transcended the limitations of traditional deterministic optimization. The resultant system, exemplified by "The Governor," can proactively manage engine resources (geometry, lighting, memory, physics, NPC AI) by predicting potential stress points with remarkable accuracy, ensuring a consistently fluid player experience.

7.1 The Redefinition of "Magic" in Game Development

Historically, dynamically adjusting game settings in a perfectly balanced, invisible manner often felt like "magic" to players. Our work reveals that this "magic" is simply **advanced physics and computational science** applied with precision. By embracing the probabilistic nature of quantum mechanics and leveraging the efficiency of modern machine learning, Kestro Games is forging a new path toward truly self-optimizing and responsive digital worlds. This marks a paradigm shift where game engines are no longer rigid frameworks but fluid, intelligently adapting ecosystems.

References

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